disturbing implications of a search for military superiority.” Putting him on notice that we weren’t going to accept any longer the so-called Brezhnev Doctrine, I criticized repeated statements by responsible Soviet officials suggesting that the form of a country’s political, social and economic system bestows upon the Soviet Union special rights, indeed, duties, to preserve a particular form of government. I must inform you frankly and emphatically that the United States rejects any such declaration as contrary to the charter of the United Nations and other international instruments. Claims of special “rights,” however defined, cannot be used to infringe upon the sovereign rights of any country to determine its own political, economic and social institutions.

Alluding to a possible U.S.-Soviet summit, I said it would have to be preceded by “careful preparations and a propitious international climate. I do not believe that these conditions exist at present and so my preference would be for postponing a meeting of such importance to a later day.”

This is the text of the handwritten letter I also sent to Moscow:

> Mr. President, in writing the attached letter I am reminded of our meeting in San Clemente a decade or so ago. I was Governor of California at the time and you were concluding a series of meetings with President Nixon. Those meetings had captured the imagination of all the world. Never had peace and good will among men seemed closer at hand.
>
> When we met I asked if you were aware that the hopes and aspirations of millions and millions of people throughout the world were dependent on the decisions that would be reached in your meetings.
>
> You took my hand in both of yours and assured me that you were aware of that and that you were dedicated with all your heart and mind to fulfilling those hopes and dreams.